Doce Perdição

Action Plan

Pre Launch Through to London Expansion

June 2026

Phase 1. Pre Launch (Months 1 to 3)

The first three months are about getting the foundations right. No shortcuts. Every task in this phase must be complete before signing a lease or ordering equipment. The goal is to enter Month 4 with a signed lease, a formalised bakery agreement, all licences applied for, and a clear fitout plan.

#	Task	Owner	Timeline	Status
1	Register company (Ltd) with Companies House	Owner	Month 1, Week 1	Pending
2	Open business bank account	Owner	Month 1, Week 1-2	Pending
3	Draft and sign bakery supply agreement with Doce Perdição	Owner	Month 1, Week 1-2	Pending
4	Agree wholesale pricing and delivery schedule with bakery	Owner	Month 1, Week 2	Pending
5	Research Epsom outskirts commercial units (600-800 sq ft)	Owner	Month 1, Week 1-3	Pending
6	Visit shortlisted units, assess footfall and parking	Owner	Month 1-2	Pending
7	Negotiate lease terms (seek 18 month break clause)	Owner	Month 2	Pending
8	Sign lease and pay deposit	Owner	Month 2-3	Pending
9	Apply for food hygiene registration with local council	Owner	Month 2	Pending
10	Apply for premises licence (alcohol for Sangria, Carajillo)	Owner	Month 2	Pending
11	Obtain public liability and employer liability insurance	Owner	Month 2-3	Pending
12	Source espresso machine and grinder (research Portuguese roasters)	Owner	Month 2-3	Pending
13	Design Iberian fitout (azulejo tiles, colour scheme, furniture)	Owner + Designer	Month 2-3	Pending
14	Get fitout quotes from at least 3 contractors	Owner	Month 3	Pending
15	Source azulejo tile panels (printed ceramic or hand painted)	Owner	Month 3	Pending
16	Set up accounting software (Xero or FreeAgent)	Owner	Month 1	Pending
17	Register for VAT if projected turnover exceeds threshold	Owner	Month 1	Pending
18	Create Instagram account and begin pre launch content	Owner	Month 2	Pending
19	Design logo, menu boards, and signage	Owner + Designer	Month 2-3	Pending
20	Build simple website (menu, location, story, contact)	Owner	Month 3	Pending

Month 5. Verify that the premises licence has been granted before serving alcohol at the soft launch. If the licence is still pending, the soft launch must exclude alcoholic drinks (serve only coffee, food, and non alcoholic beverages). Alcohol service begins only when the licence is confirmed.

Month 4 to 5. Prepare the HACCP food safety management system documentation (use the Food Standards Agency's Safer Food Better Business template). Set up cleaning schedules, temperature monitoring logs for fridges and warming ovens, and supplier traceability records for all food deliveries. All staff must complete Level 2 Food Hygiene Certificates before the soft launch. Prepare written employment contracts for all staff (legally required on or before their first day of work). Arrange a commercial waste collection contract.

Month 3. Formalise the on-site baking agreement with Doce Perdição bakery. The agreement should cover the schedule (bakers arrive at 6am daily), the service fee structure, responsibility for ingredients versus labour, and use of the café's kitchen equipment. Because pastries are baked fresh on the premises (not prepacked elsewhere), Natasha's Law PPDS labelling does not apply. However, prepare an allergen information matrix covering every item on the menu. This must be available at the counter from day one. Staff must be trained to answer allergen queries for all products.

Month 2 to 3. Obtain a business insurance package covering employer liability (minimum £5 million, legal requirement), public liability (£1 million to £5 million recommended), and contents and stock cover. Apply for PRS for Music licence and PPL licence for playing background music in the café. Register with the Information Commissioner's Office for data protection (£40 annual fee) if the café will collect customer data through a loyalty scheme or email list.

Month 2. Submit food business registration to the local authority (at least 28 days before opening, registration is free). Submit premises licence application under the Licensing Act 2003 for the sale of alcohol (Sangria, Carajillo, Café com Cheirinho). Allow 28 days minimum for the consultation period. Budget for possible hearing if objections are raised. Conduct a fire risk assessment of the premises (professional assessment £150 to £300, or self assessed using government guidance). Conduct a general health and safety risk assessment.

Month 1. Owner completes a personal licence qualification (one day course, approximately £100 to £200). Submit personal licence application to Epsom and Ewell Borough Council (application fee £37). Register with HMRC for PAYE and employer National Insurance. Set up auto enrolment workplace pension scheme.

The following legal and regulatory tasks must be completed during the pre launch phase. These are in addition to the operational tasks above.

Legal and Regulatory Tasks

Decision Gate (End of Month 3)

GREEN: Lease signed, bakery agreement finalised, licences applied for, fitout plan confirmed, budget on track. Proceed to Phase 2.

AMBER: Lease negotiations delayed or unit selection not finalised. Extend search by 4 weeks maximum. Reassess if no suitable unit found.

RED: No viable unit found, bakery agreement falls through, or startup budget exceeds £85,000. Pause the project. Reassess feasibility before committing further capital.

Phase 2. Fitout and Soft Launch (Months 4 to 5)

This phase transforms the empty unit into an Iberian café. The fitout is the most visible and expensive part of the launch. It needs to be done right because the interior is the product. A half finished or generic fitout undermines the entire concept.

#	Task	Owner	Timeline	Status
1	Begin Iberian fitout (azulejo feature wall, painting, flooring)	Contractor	Month 4, Week 1-3	Pending
2	Install counter area (wooden counter, glass pastry cabinet)	Contractor	Month 4, Week 2-3	Pending
3	Install lighting (ceramic pendants, warm sconces)	Contractor + Electrician	Month 4, Week 3	Pending
4	Receive and install espresso machine and grinder	Owner	Month 4, Week 3-4	Pending
5	Install warming oven, fridge, and prep area	Owner	Month 4, Week 3-4	Pending
6	Install POS system and configure menu	Owner	Month 4, Week 4	Pending
7	Receive and arrange furniture	Owner	Month 4, Week 4	Pending
8	Set up outdoor bistro tables (if space allows)	Owner	Month 4, Week 4	Pending
9	Source and arrange décor (herbs, posters, bookshelf)	Owner	Month 5, Week 1	Pending
10	Install exterior signage	Contractor	Month 5, Week 1	Pending
11	Advertise and hire 2 staff (1 full time, 1 part time)	Owner	Month 4-5	Pending
12	Train staff on Iberian coffee preparations (Bica, Galão, Cortado, Bombón)	Owner	Month 5, Week 1-2	Pending
13	Train staff on in house Spanish food prep (churros, tortilla)	Owner	Month 5, Week 1-2	Pending
14	Run test batches with bakery delivery (timing, quantities)	Owner + Bakery	Month 5, Week 2	Pending
15	Soft launch event for friends, family, local contacts	Owner	Month 5, Week 3	Pending
16	Collect feedback from soft launch and adjust	Owner	Month 5, Week 3-4	Pending
17	Set up loyalty card programme	Owner	Month 5, Week 4	Pending

Decision Gate (End of Month 5)

GREEN: Fitout complete, staff trained, soft launch feedback positive, bakery deliveries running smoothly. Proceed to grand opening.

AMBER: Fitout delayed by 1 to 2 weeks, or staff training needs more time. Push grand opening to Month 7. Not ideal but manageable.

RED: Fitout significantly over budget (more than 20%), major equipment failure, or bakery delivery problems unresolved. Delay opening until issues are fixed. Do not open with a compromised product.

Phase 3. Grand Opening and Year 1 (Months 6 to 12)

The grand opening is the beginning, not the end. The first six months after opening are about building consistent daily footfall, getting the operations right, and proving the concept works in Epsom. Expect some waste, some quiet days, and some adjustments.

#	Task	Owner	Timeline	Status
1	Grand opening event	Owner + Staff	Month 6, Week 1	Pending
2	Launch Instagram and social media push	Owner	Month 6, Week 1	Pending
3	Distribute leaflets to residential streets (1 mile radius)	Owner + Staff	Month 6, Week 1-2	Pending
4	Invite local food bloggers for complimentary visit	Owner	Month 6, Week 1-2	Pending
5	Post in Epsom community Facebook groups	Owner	Month 6, Week 1	Pending
6	Track daily customer count and average spend	Owner	Ongoing	Pending
7	Optimise bakery order quantities based on actual demand	Owner	Month 7-8	Pending
8	Adjust staffing to match peak and quiet periods	Owner	Month 7-8	Pending
9	Request Google and TripAdvisor reviews from customers	Staff	Ongoing	Pending
10	Introduce seasonal menu item (e.g. winter churros special)	Owner	Month 9-10	Pending
11	Review financials against model at 6 month mark	Owner	Month 12	Pending
12	Assess break even progress	Owner	Month 12	Pending

Decision Gate (End of Month 12)

GREEN: Daily customers averaging 50 or more, break even achieved or within sight, customer feedback consistently positive, bakery supply stable. Continue operations and begin planning Year 2 growth.

AMBER: Daily customers averaging 35 to 50, break even not yet reached but trend is upward. Increase marketing spend, consider local partnerships, assess whether location is the bottleneck. Allow 6 more months before reassessing.

RED: Daily customers consistently below 35, significant losses, or bakery supply issues. Serious reassessment needed. Consider whether to relocate, renegotiate lease, or wind down. Trigger the break clause if available.

Phase 4. Stabilisation (Months 13 to 48)

Years 2 to 4 are about steady improvement, not dramatic change. The café should be profitable and growing its customer base through reputation and word of mouth. The focus shifts from survival to optimisation.

#	Task	Owner	Timeline	Status
1	Maintain and grow daily customer count (target 72 Y2, 85 Y3, 90 Y4)	Owner	Ongoing	Pending
2	Seasonal menu rotations (quarterly)	Owner	Quarterly	Pending
3	Build relationships with local businesses (catering, events)	Owner	Ongoing	Pending
4	Explore evening opening on Fridays/Saturdays (if demand exists)	Owner	Year 2	Pending
5	Consider Portuguese/Spanish cultural events quarterly	Owner	Quarterly	Pending
6	Annual review of bakery supply terms	Owner	Annual	Pending
7	Equipment maintenance and replacement planning	Owner	Annual	Pending
8	Build cash reserves for London expansion	Owner	Ongoing	Pending
9	Begin London market research (Year 3 onwards)	Owner	Year 3-4	Pending
10	Visit target London areas (Stockwell, Brixton, Peckham)	Owner	Year 4	Pending

Decision Gate (End of Month 48)

GREEN: Epsom consistently profitable for 3 or more years, cash reserves sufficient for London startup (£115,000), target London areas researched, suitable unit identified. Proceed to Phase 5.

AMBER: Epsom profitable but inconsistent, or cash reserves below target. Delay London by 12 months. Do not open a second site while the first is uncertain.

RED: Epsom has not demonstrated consistent profitability over 4 years. Do not proceed with London. Focus on making the single site work or consider whether the concept has a ceiling.

Phase 5. London Expansion (Months 49 to 60)

London is not guaranteed. It is conditional on Epsom proving the model over four years. If the decision gate at Month 48 is green, the London expansion follows a similar pattern to the Epsom launch but with higher costs and higher footfall expectations.

#	Task	Owner	Timeline	Status
1	Final decision to proceed with London expansion	Owner	Month 49	Pending
2	Search for units in target areas (Stockwell, Brixton, Peckham)	Owner	Month 49-52	Pending
3	Negotiate lease terms for London unit	Owner	Month 52-54	Pending
4	Adapt Iberian fitout design for London unit	Owner + Designer	Month 54-55	Pending
5	Complete London fitout	Contractor	Month 55-57	Pending
6	Hire London team (manager + 2 to 3 staff)	Owner	Month 55-57	Pending
7	Arrange bakery delivery logistics to London	Owner + Bakery	Month 56-57	Pending
8	Soft launch London site	Owner + London Manager	Month 57-58	Pending
9	Grand opening London	Owner + London Manager	Month 58-59	Pending
10	Monitor London performance against model	Owner	Month 59-60	Pending

Decision Gate (End of Month 60)

GREEN: London site trading, daily customers approaching target (110/day), Epsom site continuing at steady state. Two site model working. Begin planning potential third site.

AMBER: London footfall below target but trending upward. Give it 12 more months to establish. Do not open a third site until London proves itself.

RED: London site significantly underperforming. Losses exceeding model. Reassess location, marketing, or concept fit for the chosen area. Consider closing the London site to protect the Epsom business.

Budget Summary

Phase	Budget	Timing	Funding
Epsom Startup (Phase 1-2)	£68,000	Months 1-5	Bootstrap / savings
Epsom Operations (Phase 3-4)	Funded by revenue	Months 6-48	Self sustaining
London Startup (Phase 5)	~£115,000	Months 49-58	Retained profits + savings
Total (if London proceeds)	**~£183,000**	5 years	No external investment

The entire plan is designed to be bootstrap friendly. No loans. No investors. No external pressure to grow faster than the business can support. Each phase is funded either by savings (Epsom) or by retained profits from the operating business (London). If the profits are not there, the expansion does not happen.